

Appendix 7: Canadian Sustainable Development Objectives

The Commissioner of the Environment and



Sustainable Development was set up in 1995 as an amendment to the Auditor General Act. This means that each governmental department must prepare sustainable development strategies and table them in Parliament.

Meeting our International Obligations

Canada cooperates with other countries on transboundary issues such as climate change, ozone depletion, and resource conservation. Examples of intervention.

Promoting Equity

Sustainable development involves a two-dimensional commitment to equity: between the current generation and those that will follow; and between the poor and the more affluent. This involves the fair distribution of costs and benefits between generations and between the nations of the North and the South.

Improving Quality of Life and Well-being

Quality of Life is the overarching goal of sustainable development. People depend on the environment and the economy to meet their basic needs and improve their quality of life. The challenge is to achieve economic growth while still protecting the environment. Environmental efficiency is a key dimension to economic growth, and translates into producing more with less. For example, environmental improvements such as better energy, water efficiency, waste minimization and pollution prevention result in the reduction of inputs and essentially lead to a reduction in costs. This involves continuous attention to research

and development and results oriented policies with greater emphasis on the environmental and economic implications.

Protecting the Health of Canadians and of Ecosystems

One of the greatest challenges posed by sustainable development is pollution. The Canadian government has taken two approaches to dealing with pollution: 1) Pollution prevention and 2) Recycling. These two strategies are incorporated into the draft "Pollution Prevention: A Federal Strategy for Action" which sets priorities for the federal government to internalize pollution prevention within Canadian society.

Sustaining our Natural Resources – Sustainable Jobs, Communities and Industries

For the proper management of natural resources, there is a need for sound ecological and environmental practices. An integrated approach to the management of renewable resources is needed which recognizes the full range of uses and values, including commodities production, habitat for wildlife, parks and wilderness. Government strategies for managing renewable resources include the National Forest Strategy, the update of the Agriculture-Environment Strategy, and the Ocean Management Strategy. The efficient use of non-renewable resources must also be ensured through both sound policies which encourage efficient extraction and manufacturing processes and uses and by policies and programs which stimulate recycling or the development of substitutes.¹⁷

¹⁷ Government of Canada. 2002-06-19.

"What is Sustainable Development"

http://sdinfo.gc.ca/what_is_sd/index_e.cfm